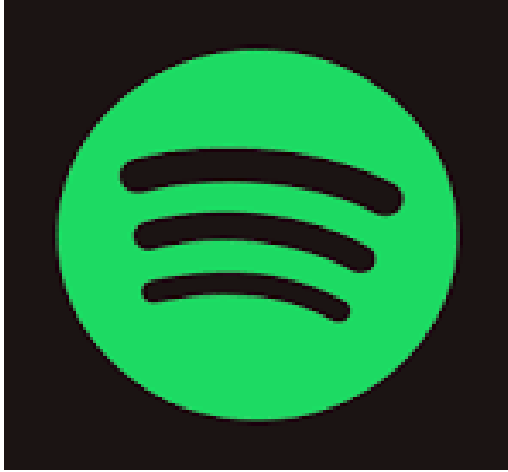




LISTENING RHYTHM- SPOTIFY BURNOUT DETECTOR

Just a concept

ABSTRACT

Listening Rhythm is a privacy-first Spotify feature that helps users recognize meaningful changes in their listening habits through behavioral insights, without making clinical assumptions. It empowers users with ethical, transparent, and personalized recommendations while maintaining complete control over their data and experience.

Aarushi Singh

Product Requirement Document

Listening Rhythm

Burnout Pattern Detection for Spotify Premium

Author: Aarushi Singh

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1. Executive Summary

Listening Rhythm is an opt-in behavioral wellness feature designed for Spotify Premium users. Instead of attempting to detect mental health conditions, the feature identifies meaningful changes in listening behavior that may indicate increased stress or burnout.

The objective is to help users become more aware of their listening habits through reflective insights while maintaining Spotify's identity as a music platform rather than a healthcare application.

The feature uses only existing listening metadata and introduces no biometric, lyric or medical data collection.

2. Problem Statement

Millions of users use Spotify as an emotional regulator. However, Spotify currently reacts only to musical preferences, ignores behavioral patterns and even the users experiencing burnout often do not recognize subtle changes in their habits.

Examples include:

- Listening until 3-4 AM every night
- Repeating identical playlists or listening to the same song on loop
- Abandoning music discovery
- Increased passive listening

Spotify records all these signals but derives no value for the user beyond recommendations.

3. Product Vision

"Empower Spotify users to better understand their listening rhythms through privacy-first, non-clinical behavioral insights that encourage self-awareness, foster healthier listening habits, and build long-term trust in personalized experiences."

Help users reflect on changing listening habits in a respectful, private and non-clinical way. Spotify should never diagnose, it should simply surface patterns.

Listening Rhythm aims to make Spotify a more thoughtful and user-centric platform by helping users recognize meaningful changes in their listening habits without making assumptions about their mental or emotional state. The feature transforms existing listening metadata into simple, easy-to-understand behavioral insights that encourage self-reflection while respecting user privacy and autonomy.

The vision is to create a feature that feels supportive rather than intrusive. Instead of acting as a wellness or healthcare tool, *Listening Rhythm* serves as a gentle companion that helps users understand how their listening patterns evolve over time. By surfacing subtle behavioral shifts through transparent, opt-in insights, Spotify can empower users to make informed choices about their listening habits while maintaining complete control over their data and experience.

Ultimately, *Listening Rhythm* seeks to strengthen user trust by demonstrating that personalization can be both meaningful and privacy-first. It reinforces Spotify's mission of connecting people with the right music at the right time, while introducing a new dimension of personalization that is ethical, transparent, and centered on user well-being rather than diagnosis.

4. Objectives

The primary objective of *Listening Rhythm* is to help Spotify users become more aware of changes in their listening habits by providing privacy-first, behavioral insights that encourage self-reflection without making clinical assumptions. The feature aims to create a more personalized and trustworthy listening experience while reinforcing Spotify's commitment to ethical product design.

Primary Objective

- Enable users to recognize meaningful shifts in their listening behavior through clear, non-diagnostic insights derived from existing listening metadata.

User Objectives

- Help users understand how their listening habits evolve over time.
- Encourage healthier and more intentional listening behaviors through subtle recommendations rather than interruptions.
- Provide users with complete control over how their listening data is analyzed and presented.
- Offer meaningful insights that are informative, easy to interpret, and free from medical or psychological labels.
- Build confidence by ensuring transparency, privacy, and user consent at every stage of the experience.

Product Objectives

- Introduce a new layer of personalization based on behavioral patterns instead of only musical preferences.
- Leverage existing Spotify listening metadata to generate valuable user insights without collecting additional sensitive information.
- Deliver insights through a seamless, non-intrusive experience integrated into the existing Spotify interface.
- Maintain consistency with Spotify's brand identity by ensuring the feature feels supportive, lightweight, and optional.
- Establish a scalable framework that can support future wellness-oriented personalization features while adhering to strict ethical guidelines.

Business Objectives

- Increase user engagement by encouraging users to interact with personalized listening insights and curated "Reset Playlists."
- Improve Premium user retention by delivering additional value beyond music recommendations.
- Strengthen user trust through transparent data practices and privacy-first design principles.
- Differentiate Spotify from competing music streaming platforms by introducing an ethical, behavior-driven personalization feature.
- Increase long-term user satisfaction without relying on intrusive notifications or engagement-driven dark patterns.

Success Objectives

The feature will be considered successful if it can:

- Achieve a high user opt-in rate, indicating trust in the feature.
- Maintain a low opt-out rate after users receive their first insight.
- Increase engagement with Reset Playlists and Weekly Rhythm Reports.
- Encourage greater listening diversity and re-engagement with discovery features such as Discover Weekly.
- Improve overall user satisfaction while maintaining strict privacy and ethical standards.

5. User Persona

Primary Persona

Khushi

Age: 25 years

Occupation: Product Designer

Location: Bangalore, India

Subscription: Spotify Premium

Listening Time: 3–5 hours daily

Devices: Smartphone, Laptop, Wireless Earbuds

Tech Savviness: High

Background

Khushi is a busy product designer working in a fast-paced technology company. Her work often involves long hours, multiple deadlines, and frequent collaboration across teams. Music has become an integral part of her daily routine - it accompanies her during work, late-night design sessions, commuting, workouts and moments of relaxation.

Over time, Spotify has learned her musical preferences and consistently provides personalized recommendations. However, due to increasing work pressure, Khushi's listening habits have gradually shifted. She spends more time listening late at night, repeatedly plays the same lo-fi playlists, and has become less interested in discovering new music. These changes have developed slowly enough that she hasn't consciously noticed them.

Listening Rhythm aims to surface these subtle behavioral shifts in a respectful, data-driven manner, helping Khushi reflect on her habits without making assumptions about her emotional or mental state.

Goals

- Enjoy music that complements different parts of her day.
- Discover new artists and playlists without overwhelming recommendations.
- Maintain a healthy balance between productivity and relaxation.
- Understand how her listening habits evolve over time.
- Receive personalized insights that are informative without feeling intrusive.

Motivations

- Uses music to improve focus during work.
- Relies on playlists to unwind after stressful days.
- Values products that prioritize privacy and transparency.
- Appreciates meaningful personalization over generic recommendations.
- Wants technology to support her lifestyle rather than constantly demand her attention.

Pain Points

- Doesn't notice gradual changes in her listening behavior.
- Finds repetitive listening habits difficult to recognize.
- Can become trapped in the same playlists for weeks.
- Would dislike notifications implying she is stressed or emotionally struggling.
- Values privacy and is cautious about products that infer sensitive personal information.

Listening Behavior

- Frequently listens during late-night work sessions.
- Uses instrumental and lo-fi playlists while working.
- Repeats familiar playlists when feeling mentally exhausted.
- Has recently reduced engagement with Discover Weekly and Release Radar.
- Searches for fewer new artists than before.
- Increasingly listens passively rather than actively exploring music.

Technology Usage

- Uses Spotify across multiple devices throughout the day.
- Connects Spotify with smart speakers and Bluetooth headphones.
- Regularly explores Wrapped, Blend, and AI DJ features.
- Comfortable enabling optional personalization features when privacy practices are clearly explained.

Needs

Khushi needs a feature that quietly highlights meaningful changes in her listening behavior without making her feel judged or monitored. She values complete control over her data, expects transparency in how insights are generated, and prefers suggestions that empower her to make her own decisions rather than directing her behavior.

What Khushi Says — *"I don't need Spotify to tell me how I'm feeling. I just want it to help me notice patterns I might have missed and let me decide what they mean."*

6. Product Goals

Listening Rhythm is designed to extend Spotify's personalization capabilities beyond music recommendations by helping users better understand their listening behaviors over time. The feature aims to create a more mindful and engaging listening experience while maintaining Spotify's core philosophy of simplicity, trust, and user-first design. Every product goal is centered around enhancing user value without compromising privacy or making clinical interpretations.

Deliver Meaningful Personalization

Move beyond traditional recommendation systems by analyzing changes in listening behavior rather than only musical preferences. Listening Rhythm should provide contextual insights that help users understand how their habits evolve over time, making personalization feel more intelligent and relevant.

Encourage User Self-Awareness

Enable users to recognize gradual shifts in their listening patterns that may otherwise go unnoticed. By presenting behavioral observations instead of conclusions, the feature empowers users to interpret these insights according to their own experiences.

Preserve User Trust Through Ethical Design

Trust is a fundamental objective of this feature. Listening Rhythm should be transparent about what data is collected, how it is processed, and why insights are generated. Every interaction should reinforce that the feature exists to support users rather than monitor or profile them. Key Principles include:

- Explicit user content
- Transparent data usage
- Easy opt-out and data deletion
- No advertising or market use of feature data
- No clinical labeling or diagnosis

Increase User Engagement

Encourage users to interact with Spotify in more meaningful ways by introducing Weekly Rhythm Reports and Reset Playlists. Rather than increasing engagement through notifications or interruptions, the feature should naturally encourage users to revisit discovery features, explore new music and diversify their listening habits.

Enhance Premium Value Proposition

Listening Rhythm should provide Premium subscribers with an exclusive value-added experience that complements existing features such as AI DJ, Wrapped, Blend, and personalized playlists. By offering behavioral insights that free users do not receive, Spotify can further differentiate its Premium offering and improve subscriber retention.

Differentiate Spotify in the Streaming Market

Introduce a unique form of behavioral personalization that competitors currently do not offer. By focusing on ethical, privacy-first behavioral insights rather than algorithmic engagement optimization, Spotify can position itself as an industry leader in responsible personalization and user-centric product innovation.

7. Success Metrics (KPIs)

The success of Listening Rhythm will be measured by evaluating user adoption, engagement, trust, retention and overall product impact. Since the feature is designed to promote self-awareness rather than diagnose or maximize engagement, success metrics focus on user value, transparency and long-term satisfaction instead of increasing app usage.

North Star Metric

Percentage of users who actively engage with Listening Rhythm insights while remaining opted into the feature after 30 days. This metric captures both adoption and sustained value, indicating whether users find the feature trustworthy and useful over time.

Primary Success Metrics:

- **Opt-in rate:**

Measures the percentage of eligible Premium users who voluntarily enable Listening Rhythm after viewing the onboarding card. Target: 25-35%

- **Weekly Rhythm Report Engagement:**

Measures how many users open and interact with their Weekly Rhythm Report after receiving an insight. This includes:

- Report opens
- Average viewing time
- Scroll Completion Rate
- Interaction with report states

Target: 60%

- **Reset playlist Options:**

Measures the percentage of users who choose the "Reset Playlist" recommendation after viewing their Weekly Rhythm Report. This indicates whether users perceive the recommendations as valuable and relevant.

Target: 30-40%

User Engagement Metrics

These metrics evaluate how Listening Rhythm influences user interaction with Spotify.

Increased Discovery Engagement

Track changes in:

- Discover weekly plays

- Release radar interactions
- New artist exploration
- Playlist diversity

Listening Diversity Score

Measure changes in:

- Number of unique artists
- Number of genres explored
- Variety of playlists
- Audio feature playlists

Business Metrics

Although Listening Rhythm is not intended as a revenue-generating feature, it should contribute positively to Spotify's Premium ecosystem.

Measure:

- Premium Retention Rates
- Average Listening Sessions
- User Satisfaction (NPS)
- Premium Renewal Rate
- Weekly-active users who opted-in

Long-term Success Metrics

Over a six to twelve-month period, Spotify should evaluate whether Listening Rhythm contributes to broader product goals.

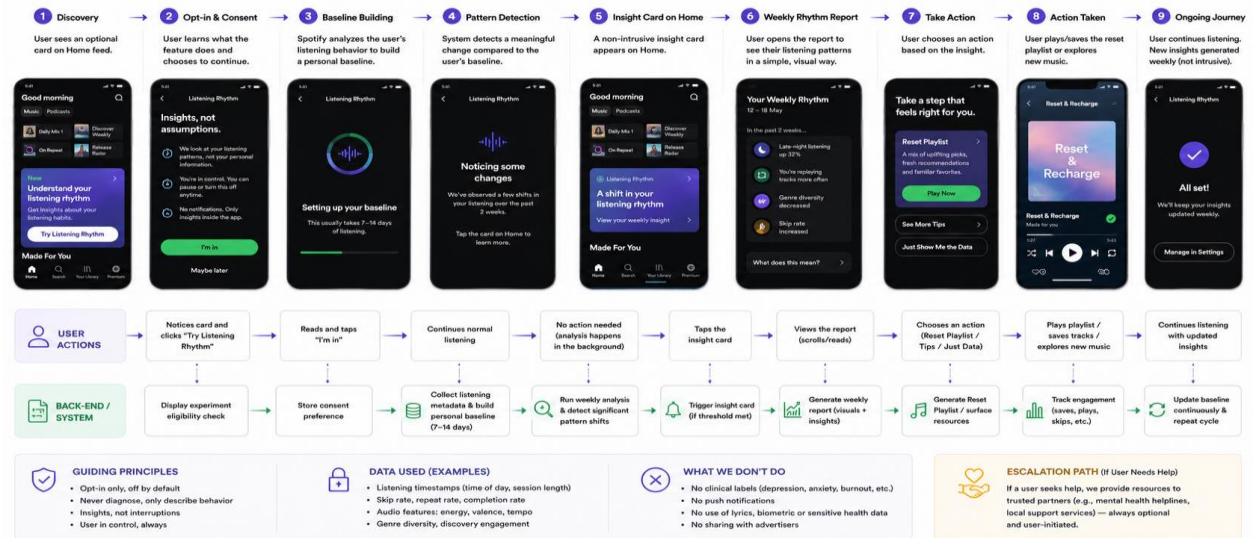
This includes:

- Increased Premium Retention
 - Higher trust in Spotify personalization
 - Positive qualitative feedback from users
 - Sustainable feature adoption without relying on notifications
-

8. User Journey

-||- Listening Rhythm – User Journey Flow

A high-level view of how a user discovers, opts in, receives insights and takes action.



9. Future Enhancements

While the initial version of Listening Rhythm focuses on providing privacy-first behavioral insights, the feature has the potential to evolve into a broader personalization ecosystem that continues to respect user autonomy and trust. Future iterations can introduce richer analytics, smarter recommendations, and deeper integrations without compromising Spotify's commitment to ethical design.

Future Enhancements may include:

- **Monthly Listening Wellness Reports** that provide long-term trends and highlight meaningful changes in listening behavior over weeks or months.
- **Personalized Mood Journey Visualizations** that allow users to explore how their listening rhythms have evolved over time through interactive charts and timelines.
- **Focus and Productivity Modes** that recommend music optimized for studying, working, exercising, or relaxing based on historical listening habits.
- **Custom Wellness Goals**, enabling users to set personal objectives such as increasing music discovery, reducing repetitive listening, or maintaining a balanced listening routine.
- **Context-Aware Recommendations** that adapt playlists based on factors such as time of day, weekday versus weekend, travel, or work routines while remaining non-intrusive.

These enhancements would allow Listening Rhythm to grow from a single reflective feature into a comprehensive behavioral personalization platform, strengthening Spotify's Premium ecosystem while continuing to prioritize user trust, transparency, and ethical product innovation.

Aarushi Singh